# Just this once...

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/46031026.

**Rating:**
General Audiences

**Archive Warning:**
No Archive Warnings Apply

**Category:**
F/F

**Fandom:**
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

**Relationship:**
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

**Characters:**
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Horde Prime (She-Ra), Horde Prime Clones (She-Ra)

**Additional Tags:**
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018) Season 5 Spoilers, Angst with a Happy Ending, Dark, Self-Sacrifice, Self-Hatred, POV Catra (She-Ra), Episode: s05e05 Save The Cat

**Language:**
English

**Series:**
Part 5 of English Fics

**Stats:**
Published: 2023-03-26 Words: 642 Chapters: 1/1

# Just this once...

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/46031026.

**Rating:**
General Audiences

**Archive Warning:**
No Archive Warnings Apply

**Category:**
F/F

**Fandom:**
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

**Relationship:**
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

**Characters:**
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Horde Prime (She-Ra), Horde Prime Clones (She-Ra)

**Additional Tags:**
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018) Season 5 Spoilers, Angst with a Happy Ending, Dark, Self-Sacrifice, Self-Hatred, POV Catra (She-Ra), Episode: s05e05 Save The Cat

**Language:**
English

**Series:**
Part 5 of English Fics

**Stats:**
Published: 2023-03-26 Words: 642 Chapters: 1/1

# Just this once...

by Solaris_Quid

Summary

Catra is surrounded by shadows and darkness after Horde Prime took over. Then, suddenly, a bright, warm light appears. A beacon of hope that won't let her die.

Notes

I wanted to thank Etherean Frog for helping me out with polishing the fic. I really appreciate it and as with the rest of my fics, this wouldn't exist without you. So thanks for everything! :D

Note: Dialogues in **bold** are supposed to be read as yells, because that's how Catra perceives them, even if outside her mind they are actually whispers.

I hope you enjoy it!

See the end of the work for more notes

"You look out for me. And I look out for you. Nothing really bad can happen as long as we have each other."

"You promise?"

"I promise."

That was the last memory that crossed Catra's mind before the pain.

"It was time I did justice to that promise myself. Stay safe, Adora..."

And those were her last thoughts before being forced to submerge inside the green glowing pool. Before the shadows took over and all she could hear was Horde Prime's voice, soon enough joined by thousands upon thousands of voices in the darkness. The hivemind. Their sound was deafening and Horde Prime's will was even sicker than any punishment Shadow Weaver had ever inflicted upon Catra. So she withdrew deep into her soul, far deeper than anyone could ever reach, to slumber for eternity as Horde Prime used her as a mere puppet.

Anyone but Adora. Suddenly, a light. And Adora was there. Somehow she had managed to break Prime's mind control. She didn't remember doing so. But soon enough, Prime took over again. This happened many times in a lapse of time way too short and Catra was hurting.

The last thing she saw before being surrounded by darkness once again... Was the abyss. A deep, dark abyss. Horde Prime wanted to end her life.

The darkness surrounded her, once again. She could also feel the grip of Horde Prime, restraining her whole mind. And the shadows started to grow bigger. And bigger. And bigger.

She was dying. And all she could think was... That she deserved it. She had ruined way too many people's lives. She had broken

people, and pushed them away. A single good action couldn't redeem a monster like her. She deserved nothing, but death. The whole universe would be better off without her.

And then, among the shadows, she heard a voice. A shout, a yell. Accompanied by a light, so bright that the shadows started to retreat. So bright, that Horde Prime's light seemed like a shadow itself. So pure that she could feel Horde Prime's grip weakening, as he was burned by the light.

**"Come on, Catra, you're not done. Not yet!"**

She knew that voice. She knew it as well as she knew that the sun would rise every morning. Her heart skipped way too many heartbeats.

"Adora?"

**"We're going home, Catra! You have to wake up!"**

Then, Catra saw it. A bright, glowing door, calling her from within the shadows, attracting her. And Adora was there. Trying to reach Catra with her hand.

"Adora... I'm worthless. I hurt people. Why would you come back for me? I wanted you to be safe... To uphold my end of the promise for once. Leave me. You're better off without me."

**"No, no!"**

The sheer emotion in Adora's yells was enough to made Catra look at her. She was crying.

**"I was the one who failed you! I broke the promise, while you always looked out for me, even after I left! So don't you dare blame yourself for that!"**

"But..."

**"Don't you get it!? I know I don't deserve it, but I'm begging you! I will never leave you again, so please, just this once... Come with me!"**

Adora wasn't able to continue as she burst into tears. But her words were more than enough to make Catra feel something she hadn't felt in a long time. Hope for a better future. Hope for herself. Hope... For redemption. A will to live.

So she struggled with Horde Prime's weakened wrap. She struggled through the shadows, through the pain and through the darkness, reaching for Adora's hand, as her face filled with surprise.

When she opened her eyes, Adora was there. Leaning on her chest, feeling mentally exhausted and vulnerable... She said the only thing she could think of at the moment.

"Hey, Adora..."

End Notes

First of all and before talking about the inspiration, I wanted to explaing some things. As you have seen, this fanfic is derived from a canon scene. Any dialogue non present in canon is a verbalization of Adora's feelings by Catra's mind. Adora does not speak them out loud nor whispers them, but Catra's mind is able to translate her feelings into words. I wanted to make that clear, but I didn't think it would be necessary to put it before the fic and I didn't want a huge section of notes at the beginning.

You can read it again taking this into account if you want.

Now, secondly, the inspiration behind this fic started with me thinking about a certain Pokémon, Darkrai, who is related to shadows and nightmares. Then I realized that there was a clear paralelism between the scene where Adora heals Catra in Save the Cat and the scene in Heart Pt 2 where Catra confesses her love for Adora. And that got me thinking... Maybe in Save the Cat Catra was in a similar situation? Maybe she was also surrounded by darkness and Adora freed her? That coupled up with a detail from Heart Pt 2 that I hadn't noticed until my friend, Etherean Frog, told me: That while Catra is whispering, Adora hears those whispers as if Catra was yelling. Because of how much Catra meant to Adora.

So, to conclude... I wrote this. It had some beta versions and Etherean Frog really helped me out with polishing the fic, both with grammar and with format, so again, thanks!

I hope you all enjoyed reading this as much as I did writing it :)

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!